

SD cards are very popular but are slightly bulky in an age where everything is progressing to a smaller form factor. This led to the introduction of microSD cards which are less than a quarter the size and much thinner. Capacities range from 1GB to 64GB currently, though a 16GB card is more favourable in most aspects including price and storage space. However, if you are intent on carrying your entire music library with you all the time then invest in more memory accordingly. Though, it'd be prudent to remember that almost all devices only come with one slot for extensible memory. Also the letters SD may be succeeded by either HC (High Capacity) or XC (Extended Capacity), this relates to the capacity of the memory and nothing else. Cards between 4-32GB are labelled SDHC and those above 32GB are labelled SDXC, this has nothing to do with quality or speed. Before purchasing a memory card do find out what is the maximum that your smartphone or tablet can support, buying more than the supported amount would not necessarily work or even if it does then expect glitches.

Memory cards are graded according to their data transfer speed or class as it is called in this case. The lower class memory cards are cheaper but not by a huge margin. The following table shows the different memory classes and their respective speeds.

CLASS	MINIMUM PERFORMANCE
Class 2	2 MByte/sec
Class 4	4 MByte/sec
Class 6	6 MByte/sec
Class 10	10 MByte/sec

Near field communication

NFC is a relatively new technology that allows communication over very small distances. Currently only found on high-end phones NFC is slowly gaining popularity. More and more applications are discovered with each passing moment.



NFC is very similar to the way that RFID works, communication can be accomplished between two actively powered devices or between one active and one passive device. The first scenario is where we have two NFC devices brought close together while the latter deals with a NFC tag being swiped over a NFC device or vice versa. The technology consumes next to zero power since the transmission distance very short (often a few centimeters) for active to active communication but when a passive element is to be read, then it has to be “illuminated”(powered